

while in reality it's only stretching the picture causing a loss in image quality. It's best to turn off the digital zoom function in your camera if you're stringent about the quality of your photos. Optical zoom can be anything from 3X to even 12X.



Flash

Many casual photographers fail to see the relevance of the flash function besides 'making faces visible in the dark'. If you happen to be one of them, then pay attention, there's a lot you can do with your integrated flash. For starters, some digital cameras allow you to change the intensity level of the flash to plus (for higher flash output) or minus (lower flash output) depending on your requirement. For optimum effects in low light, it's best to move the subject as close to a natural source of light like a window with sunlight falling



A photo shot in daylight (left) but with backlighting. The harshness of the sun has entirely blocked out the subject. But using flash in daylight has made the subject visible again

through. It's also recommended to turn on all the lights in the room so that the background is not left completely dark.

Flash can also be used in daylight photography. For example, if the subject is standing right in front of the sun, you can use fill-flash to illuminate the subject so it doesn't come blacked out. You can also use fill-flash to eliminate dark, shadowy areas that lack detail.